

Project Design Phase-II

Data Flow Diagram & User Stories

Date	October 2026	Team ID	6ab75a49da631abbf0cded44
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer	Maximum Marks	4 Marks
Application / Platform	ServiceNow	Project Area	IT Procurement Automation

Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

Project Objective

Implement an automated workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer to facilitate procurement and configuration of standard laptops. The solution is intended to create a seamless request experience, reduce manual intervention and potential errors, optimise task allocation, and improve efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

Data Flow Diagrams

A Data Flow Diagram (DFD) represents how information enters and leaves the system, how it is processed, and where it is stored. For this project, the DFD below captures the documented ServiceNow request-to-task workflow.

Actor / Source	Input / Data	Process	Output	Target / Record
IT User	Standard Laptop request	Service Catalog request is submitted	Request / Requested Item created	ServiceNow Service Catalog
ServiceNow	Requested Item + approval status	Flow Designer trigger detects the Service Catalog event	Automated catalog task creation	Flow Designer
Flow Designer	Requested Item record	Create Catalog Task action populates description, assignment group and approval	Catalog task: "Laptop need to Configured" assigned to Hardware	Catalog Task record
Hardware Team	Assigned catalog task	Hardware team receives the configuration task	Laptop configuration task status updated	Catalog Tasks section

Process Flow Summary

Standard Laptop Service Catalog → Request/Approval → Flow Designer Trigger → Create Catalog Task → Assignment Group: Hardware → Hardware Configuration → Status Verification

User Stories

Use the template below to list the user stories for the ServiceNow standard laptop procurement automation product. The stories are derived from the documented problem, objective, Flow Designer activities, service catalog steps, and verification steps.

User Stories — ServiceNow Standard Laptop Automation

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User Type	Functional Requirement (Epic)	User Story Number	User Story / Task	Acceptance Criteria	Priority	Release
IT User	Standard Laptop Request	USN-1	As an IT user, I can place a Standard Laptop request through the Service Catalog so that my procurement request is recorded.	Standard Laptop is available under Service Catalog → Hardware and the user can select Order Now.	High	Release-1
IT Procurement Team	Automated Task Creation	USN-2	As a procurement team member, I want an approved Standard Laptop request to automatically create a catalog task so that configuration work is not missed.	The Flow Designer flow is triggered by the Service Catalog event and creates a Catalog Task.	High	Release-1
IT Procurement Team	Task Assignment	USN-3	As a procurement team member, I want the generated laptop configuration task assigned to the Hardware group so that the responsible team receives the work.	Assignment group is set to Hardware on the created Catalog Task.	High	Release-1
IT Procurement Team	Task Details	USN-4	As a procurement team member, I want the catalog task to contain the standard laptop configuration description so that the Hardware team knows the required task.	Short description and description are populated with "Laptop need to Configured".	Medium	Release-1
IT Procurement Team	Approval Handling	USN-5	As a procurement team member, I want the task flow to use the Approved approval state so that configuration work follows the documented approval process.	Approval field is set to Approved in the Create Catalog Task action.	High	Release-1
ServiceNow Administrator	Flow Assignment	USN-6	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can associate the Standard Laptop catalog item with the Standard Laptop Task flow so that the automation runs for that service.	Standard Laptop Maintain Item record uses the created flow and other remaining automations are removed as documented.	High	Release-1
Hardware Team	Configuration Task	USN-7	As a Hardware team member, I receive an assigned catalog task for configuring the requested laptop so that the device can be prepared promptly.	Catalog Task is visible with Hardware as the assignment group and the documented short description.	High	Release-1
IT Procurement Team	Status Verification	USN-8	As a procurement team member, I can open the Requested Item and Catalog Task records to verify the updated task status and assignment.	Requested Item contains the Catalog Tasks section and the task displays the updated status, short description and assigned group.	Medium	Release-1

Documented Implementation Milestones

Milestone	Activity	Documented Essentials
Milestone 1: Flow	Create Flow to Create Catalog Task	Flow name: Standard laptop task; Application: Global; Run user: System user; Trigger: Service Catalog; Action: Create Catalog Task; Request item from Requested Item Record; Short description and description: Laptop need to Configured; Assignment group: Hardware; Approval: Approved; Save and Activate.
Milestone 2: Flow Assignment	Assign flow to Standard Laptop service catalog item	Maintain Items → Standard Laptop → Process engine; remove remaining automations and add the Standard Laptop Task flow; save the record.

Milestone	Activity	Documented Essentials
Milestone 3: Service Catalog	Place order and verify task	Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop → Order Now; inspect request status and approvers; approve; open Requested Item; open Catalog Tasks; verify status, short description and assignment group.

Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow Flow Designer, the documented solution addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. The workflow supports timely laptop configuration, reduces user wait time, optimises resource allocation, and provides a more streamlined procurement experience.